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JERUSALEM INTERNATIONAL FELLOWS

Dear <<First Name>>,

Next week I will be in Jerusalem - my first time back in 5 months. I'll be meeting with a number of organizational leaders in East and West Jerusalem to talk about the next iteration of the residency. I'm looking forward to seeing old friends and meeting new colleagues. And being in the most beautiful, complicated city in the world. I'll share more details when I return.

The evaluators of the *2022 Jerusalem International Fellows* concluded that: ***As a pilot launched in less than optimal time constraints, the program had a resounding impact already, and with a few tweaks and improvements, can easily become a***

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The Fellows spoke eloquently about their experiences a few weeks ago on zoom. It was a wonderful "reunion."

You can listen to them on the recording [here](#).



Photo: The Fellows at the Israel Museum with Curator Amitai Mendelson

From the conclusion of the JIF Evaluation:

"The ten-weeks were filled with meaningful introductions, experiences, and creative collaborations. The nucleus was just four artists, each matched with a host organization. Together, they inspired many people in various disciplines across west and east Jerusalem."

If you are interested in artists, culture and the incredible City of

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Jerusalem, please support the future of this remarkable cultural residency program. We welcome and are grateful for contributions at every level. Join our family of [generous supporters](#).

You can [donate](#) your tax-deductible gift through the FJC Donor Advised Funds.



Photo: final presentation by students of the Ibdad School in Sheikh Jarrah, Fellow Sofia Borges on the right.

"The overwhelming number of significant relationships that were created by the artists, beyond those they made within their host organizations, far surpassed expectations."

From the artists:

ANNA:

"Overall, I made real friendships and got to understand Jerusalem on a very, very deep level-- which I think was the point. And was definitely achieved. This was an amazing life changing experience in many ways. I

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"Every residency has it's specificity. Here the orientation included engaging tours to understand some of the layers and complexities that make Jerusalem unique. I have never experienced such a strong religious culture experience. We delved into all the political, economic, and social layers in Israel, leaving room for us to pick and choose. Other residencies have the host organization explain the local scene from their own perspective. The Jerusalem Fellowship gives me more clarity. Here I think of politics as differences, which is a big change in my work."

CLAUDIA:

"They prepared us well... Then we were free to explore... like the 7 gates of the Old City. It was up to us to decide which doors we wished to enter and when...Jerusalem is a labyrinth. You need to be strong and find your way...I opened a window and found a garden. Now it will grow."

SOFIA:

"There was a shared sense of something important taking place...What we started at Ibdaa needs to continue for the sake of humanity. It was really something special that has great potential to change perspectives and enrich the children's lives through art."

You can read the full evaluation by On Track Consulting [here](#).

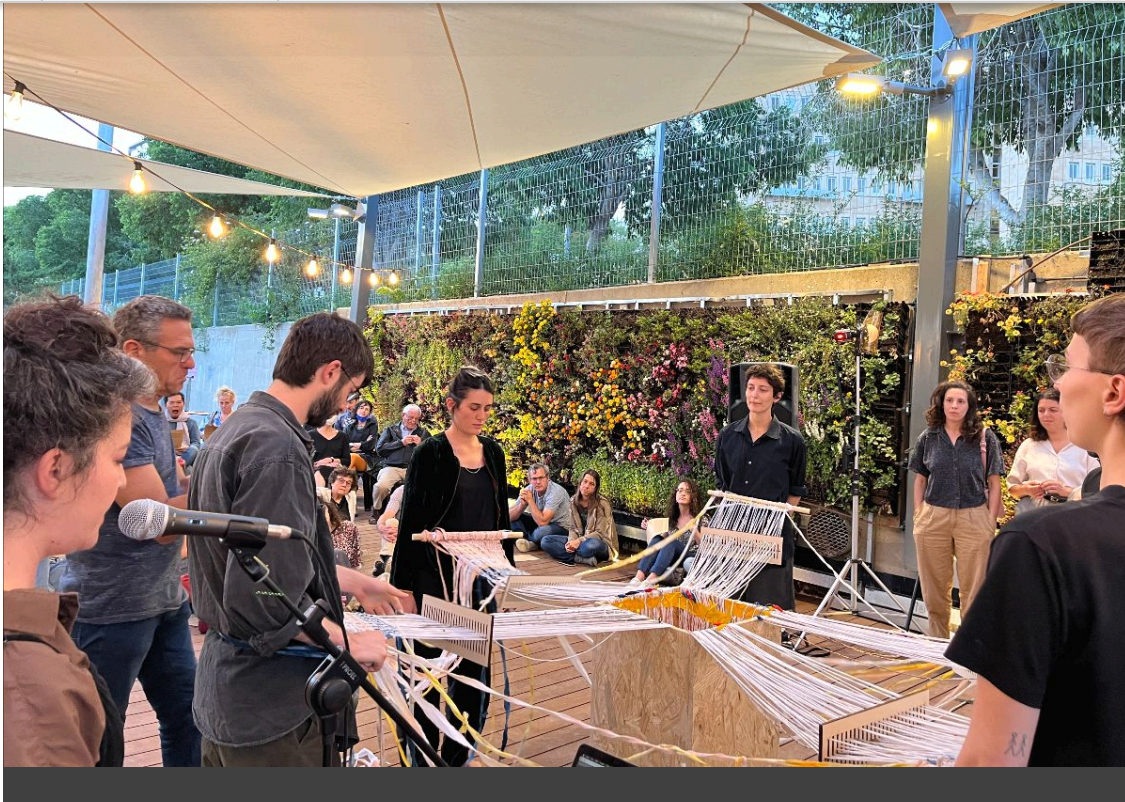
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Photo: Final Presentation of Fellow Anna Lublina at the Bloomfield Science Museum

We will continue to upload photos, videos, and reflections from our Fellows. You can also enjoy photos and videos on our Instagram [@jerusaleminternationalfellows](#).

All of the press we have received can be found [here](#).

We welcome your questions and comments and look forward to telling and showing you more about our Fellows as their connections unfold.

Thanks to all of you who have helped realize this program, which will continue to bear fruit as we start planning for the next residency in Fall 2024. Stay tuned....

Many thanks for your interest and support!

Best wishes for a happy Fall.

Elise

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